

Security Roles & Career Landscape

Blue Team Defense vs Red Team Offense

Blue team – defends: SOC, incident response, threat hunting, forensics, vulnerability management

Red team – simulates attacks: pentesting, exploit dev, red-team operations

Purple team – both, working together

Entry into security is *almost always* blue team (more roles, lower bar). Red team usually requires years of blue experience + certs (OSCP).

The SOC Tier Model

Tier	Role	Duty
Tier 1	Triage	Monitor dashboards, alert on events, escalate
Tier 2	Investigation	Deep-dive incidents, containment, malware analysis
Tier 3	Expert/Threat Hunt	Advanced analysis, hunting, tuning, forensics

Other Careers

Role	Focus
Security Engineer	Build & maintain systems (SIEM, EDR, cloud)
Pentester / Red Teamer	Authorized attacks
GRC Analyst	Governance, risk, compliance
Security Architect	Design secure systems
Digital Forensics / DFIR	Investigate incidents & crimes

Role	Focus
Threat Intelligence Analyst	Study actors & TTPs
Security Auditor	Verify controls exist & work
Bug Bounty Hunter	Find & report vulns for pay

Frameworks That Define Roles

- NIST NICE framework – 50+ work roles across 7 categories
- CyberSeek – interactive career map (US)
- OSCP / CySA+ / Security+ / CISSP – certifications per level

The Path in One Minute

- Months 0-6: networking + Linux + security fundamentals (this course)
- Months 6-12: first cert (Security+), labs, portfolio
- Months 12-24: SOC Tier 1 → Tier 2, or junior analyst
- Years 2-5: specialize (hunt, forensics, pentest, GRC, cloud)
- Years 5+: senior engineer/architect, or specialized SANS-level mastery

The meta-skill: *continuously learn*. This field changes weekly. Your superpower is a repeatable learning loop – which is exactly what this course is building.